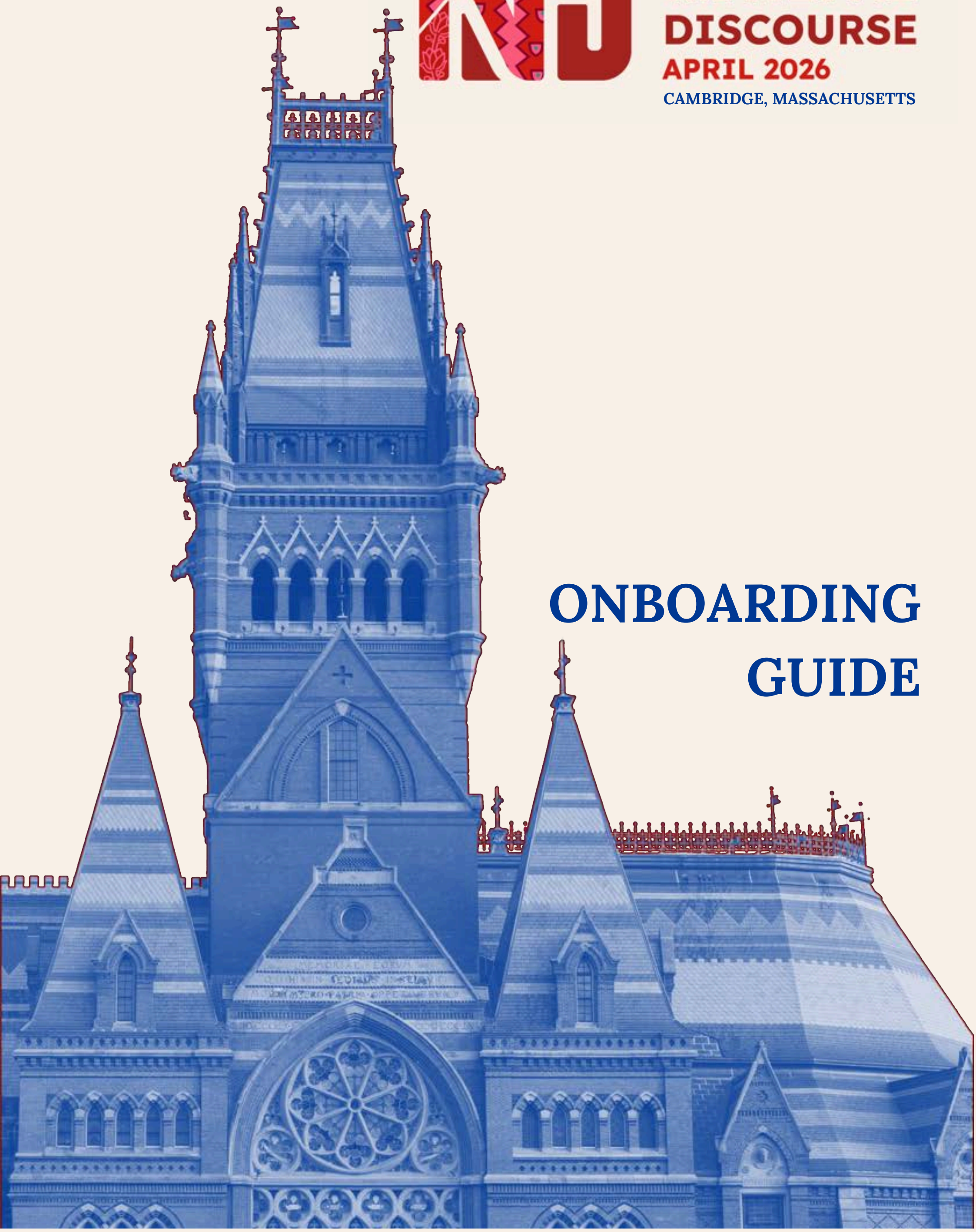
THE NEPAL DISCOURSE

APRIL 2026

CAMBRIDGE, MASSACHUSETTS



ONBOARDING GUIDE

WELCOME TO NEPAL DISCOURSE 2026

The Nepal Discourse, the first of its kind, is an initiative of students at Harvard University and Massachusetts Institute of Technology. It seeks to convene policy makers, scholars, and industry leaders from Nepal, the Nepali diaspora, and the university ecosystem for an open debate, dialogue, and discussion on the most pressing challenges and opportunities before us.

It is our pleasure to welcome you all here in this beautiful city, Cambridge, for these two days. We are honored to host such distinguished group of participants, whose distinct expertise, experience, and perspectives will enrich conversations in the conference theme: Human Capital, Artificial Intelligence, and Next Generation.

The inaugural edition of the Nepal Discourse brings together over 400 academics, policy makers, students, industry, and thought leaders across 6 panels, 12 breakout sessions, and 2 fireside chats.

Once again, we extend our warmest welcome to all participants at the Nepal Discourse 2026.

Organizing Committee
The Nepal Discourse 2026
www.thenepaldiscourse.com

Sponsors: Filps and Fuse Machines
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SCHEDULE

April 25, 2026 | Saturday Morning

8:00 AM
Breakfast and Registration
Askwith

9:00 AM
Welcome and Acknowledgment
Askwith

9:30 AM
Panel I | OPENING PLENARY:
Human Capital, AI, and Next-Gen Leadership
Askwith
Sameer Maskey | Dr. Biswash Gauchan | TBA | Anup Kaphle(M)

10:45 AM
Breakouts:

From BPO to IPO: Leveraging AI(Emerging Technology) for Startup Acceleration and Economic Leapfrogging
Larsen
Prasanna Dhungel | Bal Krishna Joshi | Karvika Thapa | Rumee Singh(M)

Future-Proofing the Curriculum: Reforming Curriculum for Human-Centric Development
Larsen
Rupa Laxmi Shah | Sulav Budathoki | William Wisser | Swastika shrestha | Dr. Arun Joshi(M)

Financing the Future: Blended Capital and Policy Pathways for Climate Resilience
Longfellow
David Sislen | Manoj Paudel | Arun Banskota | Amelia VanderLaan(M)

April 25, 2026 | Saturday Afternoon

12:00 PM
Lunch
Askwith

12:40 PM
Panel 2 | FIRESIDE CHAT:
Human Development and Institutional Resilience
Askwith
Prominent Leader from the Government of Nepal (TBA) | Moderated by Dr. Arun Joshi

1:30 PM
Breakouts:

The Cultural Playbook: Building Community and Leadership Through Art & Culture
Larsen
Sophia Pande | Sanjay Silwal Gupta | TBA | Anup Kaphle(M)

2:45 PM
Panel I | Breakout II(TBA)
Longfellow

From Prediction to Wisdom: Human Decision-Making in the AI Era
Larsen
Dr. Ashish Luitel | Sameer Maskey | Dr. Peter Q Blair | Rupa Laxmi Shah(M)

Panel 3: Mobility and Connectivity
Askwith
Michael Foley | David Silsen | TBA | Bibek Raj Kandel(M)

4:00 - 5:00PM
Poster Session and Community Hour
Longfellow

April 26, 2026 | Sunday Morning

8:00 AM

Breakfast
MIT

9:00 AM

Panel 4 | FIRESIDE CHAT: AI and the Future of Workforce
MIT
Prominent Leader from the Government of Nepal | Moderated by Dr. Peter Q. Blair

9:45 AM

Breakouts:

Next Gen Leadership: Navigating Multipolarity and Strategic Autonomy
MIT
Pukar Malla | Pukar Bam | Raksha Bam | Semanta Dahal | Ang Sonam Sherpa(M)

The Trust Deficit: Leading Institutions in the Age of Digital Mobilization and Dissent
MIT
Ashish Luitel | Sanjay Silwal | Sharad Aryan | Hitesh Hathi(M)

Nepal and Emerging Industries
MIT
Saurav Sangai | Nischal Baskota | Mohit Gupta | Shuvangi Rana(M)

11:00 AM

Panel 5: Designing Nepal's AI Skills Strategy
MIT
Dr. Sanjay Manandhar | Biswas Dhakal | Rumee Singh | Swastika Shakya | Dipta Shah(M)

April 26, 2026 | Sunday Afternoon

12:15 PM

Lunch
MIT

1:00 PM

Breakouts:

Remittance Plus Economy
MIT
Rahul Agrawal | Bhawani Rana | Subash Sapkota | Hemraj Dhakal | TBA(M)

Diaspora, Migration, and Representation
MIT
Mahendra Pandey | Nischal Baskota | Samjhana Gurung | Dadhiram Bhandari

Health and Wellbeing
MIT
Bijay Acharya | Padmashree Gehl Sampath | TBA | Dr. Ramu Kharel(M)

2:25 PM

Closing Fireside Conversation with the Keynote Speaker
MIT
Prominent Leader from the Government of Nepal
Moderated by David Sislen

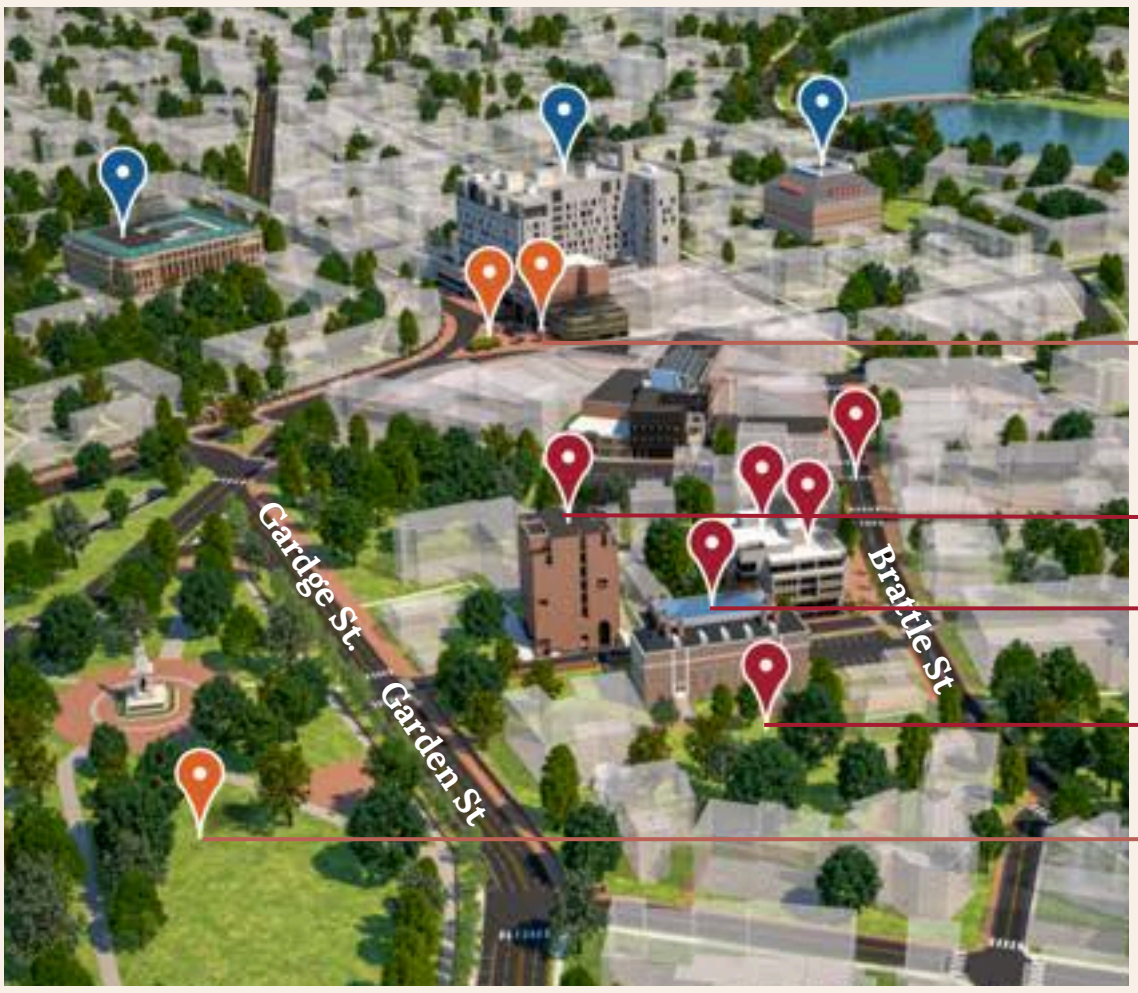
3:15 - 4:00 PM

Strategic Foresight 2035 Design and Closing Commitments
MIT

CONFERENCE LOGISTICS

The first day of the conference will take place in Harvard Graduate School of Education, located at 13 Appian Way, Cammbridge, Massachusetts, 02138.

The second day of the conference will take place in MIT Schwarzman College of Computing, located at 51 Vassar St, Cammbridge, Massachusetts, 02139.



Harvard Square

Larsen Hall

Askwith Hall @ Longfellow Hall

Entrance to Longfellow from Radcliffe Yard

Cambridge Commons

Trained volunteers and professional security will be available throughout the conference to provide logistical support and ensure a safe, orderly environment for all participants.

Accommodation Recommendations

Hotels

AC Hotel by Marriott
(2.6 miles)
10 Acorn Park Drive
Cambridge, MA 02140
Phone: 617-876-6190
Fax: 617-876-6191

Cambria Hotel Boston - Somerville
(~2 miles)
515 Somerville Avenue
Somerville, MA, 02143, US
Phone: 617-341-9040
Harvard discount available.

Sheraton Commander Hotel
(Closest to HGSE)
16 Garden Street
Cambridge, MA 02138
Main: 617-547-4800
Fax: 617-868-8322
Reservations: 800-535-5007
email: sales@shreratoncommander.com

The Charles Hotel
(Walking distance)
One Bennett Street
Cambridge, MA 02138
617-864-1200
617-864-5715

DoubleTree Suites by Hilton Hotel
(1.7 miles)
Free scheduled shuttle service available.
400 Soldiers Field Road
Boston, Massachusetts 02134
Phone: 617-783-0090
Fax: 617-783-0897

Fairmont Copley Plaza
(4.1 miles)
138 St. James Avenue
Boston, MA 02116
617-267-5300

The Freepoint Hotel
(1.6 miles)
220 Alewife Brook Parkway
Cambridge, MA, 02138
Phone: 617-491-8000

Harvard Square Hotel
(Walking distance)
110 Mt. Auburn Street
Cambridge, MA, 2138
617-864-5200
617-864-2409

Holiday Inn Express Hotel & Suites
(2.8 miles)
250 Monsignor O'Brien Highway
Cambridge, MA 02141
Phone: 617-577-7600
Fax: 617-354-1313
Ask for the Harvard University discount.

Homewood Suites by Hilton
(2.4 miles)
1 Massachusetts Ave.
Arlington, MA 02474
Phone: 781-643-7258
Take the 77 bus to Massachusetts Avenue

The Hotel Veritas
(1.4 miles)
One Remington Street
Cambridge, MA 02128
Phone: 617-520-5000

Note: These accommodations are simply recommendations, not official endorsements.

Bed and Breakfasts

A Friendly Inn at Harvard
(Walking distance)
1673 Cambridge Street
Cambridge, MA 02138
Phone: 617-547-7851
Fax: 617-547-0202

A Bed & Breakfast in Cambridge
(Walking distance)
1657 Cambridge Street #3
Cambridge, MA 02138-4316
617-868-7082 or 800-795-7122

Irving House at Harvard
(Walking distance)
24 Irving Street
Cambridge, MA 02138
Phone: 617-547-4600
Fax: 617-576-2814

The Mary Prentiss Inn
(1.5 miles, bus or subway)
6 Prentiss Street
Cambridge, MA 02140
Phone: 617-661-2929
Fax: 617-661-5989

A Cambridge House
(1.8 miles from HGSE, bus)
2218 Massachusetts Ave
Cambridge, MA, 02140
617-491-6300 ; 800-232-9989
Fax:617-868-2848

Note: These accommodations are simply recommendations, not official endorsements.

PARTICIPANT CODE OF CONDUCT

The Nepal Discourse 2026 is committed to fostering a safe, respectful, and productive environment for all participants. We believe such an environment is essential to encourage open debate, meaningful dialogue, and thoughtful discussion on the most pressing issues facing our communities. With this goal in mind, we ask all participants to adhere to the following guidelines.

By participating in the conference, you agree to adhere to the Participant Code of Conduct.

Discrimination
We will not tolerate prejudicial treatment of fellow participants on the basis of race, ethnicity, gender, gender identity or expression, sexual orientation, age, religion, nationality, disability status, or any other attributes. All participants are expected to treat one another with dignity and respect.

Harassment
Harassment of any kind is strictly prohibited. This includes, but is not limited to: sexual remarks or advances, bullying, stalking, intimidation, persistent disruption of discussions, hostile behavior, offensive or derogatory language, or threats–whether in person, in written communication, or on digital platforms associated with the event.

Substances
Participants are expected to comply with all applicable campus policies and local laws regarding alcohol and controlled substances. The use of illegal drugs, smoking, vaping, or the misuse of alcohol during conference sessions, official events, or within designated conference spaces is strictly prohibited.

Technology and Social Media
To respect participants' privacy and encourage open dialogue:

- Recording (audio or video) of sessions or individuals should only occur with prior permission from the organizers and the individuals being recorded.
- Posting photos, quotes, or session content on social media should be done responsibly and with respect for participants' consent.
- Live streaming of sessions is not permitted unless officially organized or approved by the conference team.

Solicitation
Unauthorized solicitation, including access to the conference to non-participants, the promotion or sale of products or services, distribution of marketing materials, unless authorized, is strictly prohibited during the conference.

Property Damage and Theft
Any damage to property, equipment, or facilities, as well as theft or unauthorized removal of property, will not be tolerated. Individuals found responsible may be held financially liable for damages and may face further action in accordance with applicable institutional policies.

Reporting Concerns
Anyone who experiences or observes behavior that violates this Code of Conduct is encouraged to report it to the organizing committee as soon as possible. Reports will be handled respectfully and, where possible, confidentially.

Disciplinary Action
Failure to adhere to this Participant Code of Conduct may result in appropriate action by the organizing committee, including removal from conference sessions or events, revocation of conference participation without financial compensation, and, in serious cases, restriction from attending future Nepal Discourse events.

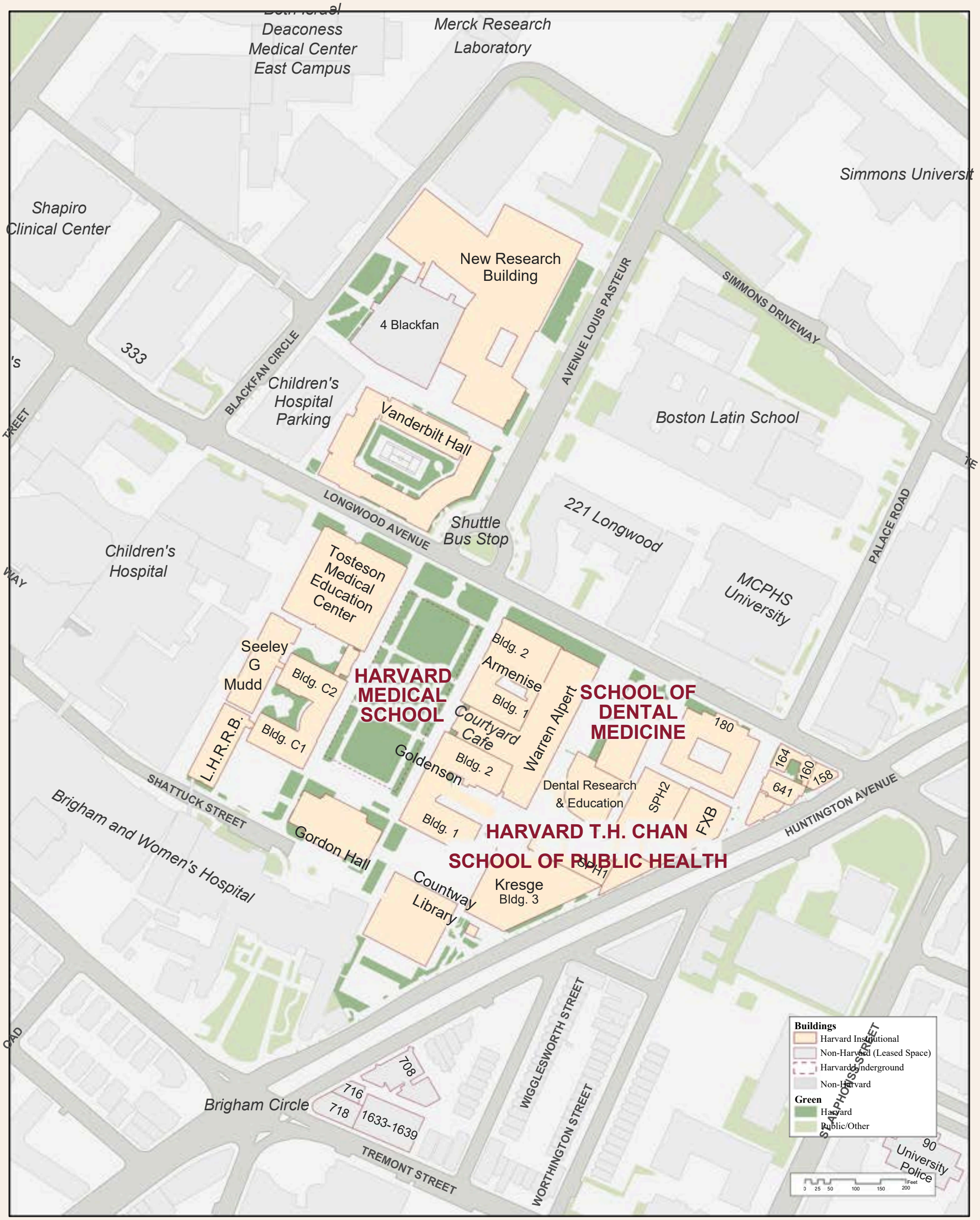
The above rules are supplementary to applicable federal laws of the United States, local laws of the City of Cambridge, and campus policies at Harvard University and the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. The Nepal Discourse 2026 is not liable for the actions of the participants. Accordingly, the responsibility for proper conduct rests with each participant.

Contact
Questions or concerns related to the Participant Code of Conduct should be directed to the organizing committee at info@thenepaldiscourse.com.

BOSTON SUBWAY T MAP

August 2025

HARVARD
University Planning and Design



HARVARD University Planning and Design

August 2025

MIT Campus Map

Welcome to MIT

All MIT buildings are designated by numbers. Under this numbering system, a single room number serves to completely identify any location on the campus. In a typical room number, such as 7-121, the figure(s) preceding the hyphen gives the building number, the first number following the hyphen, the floor, and the last two numbers, the room.

Please refer to the building index on the reverse side of this map, if the room number is unknown.

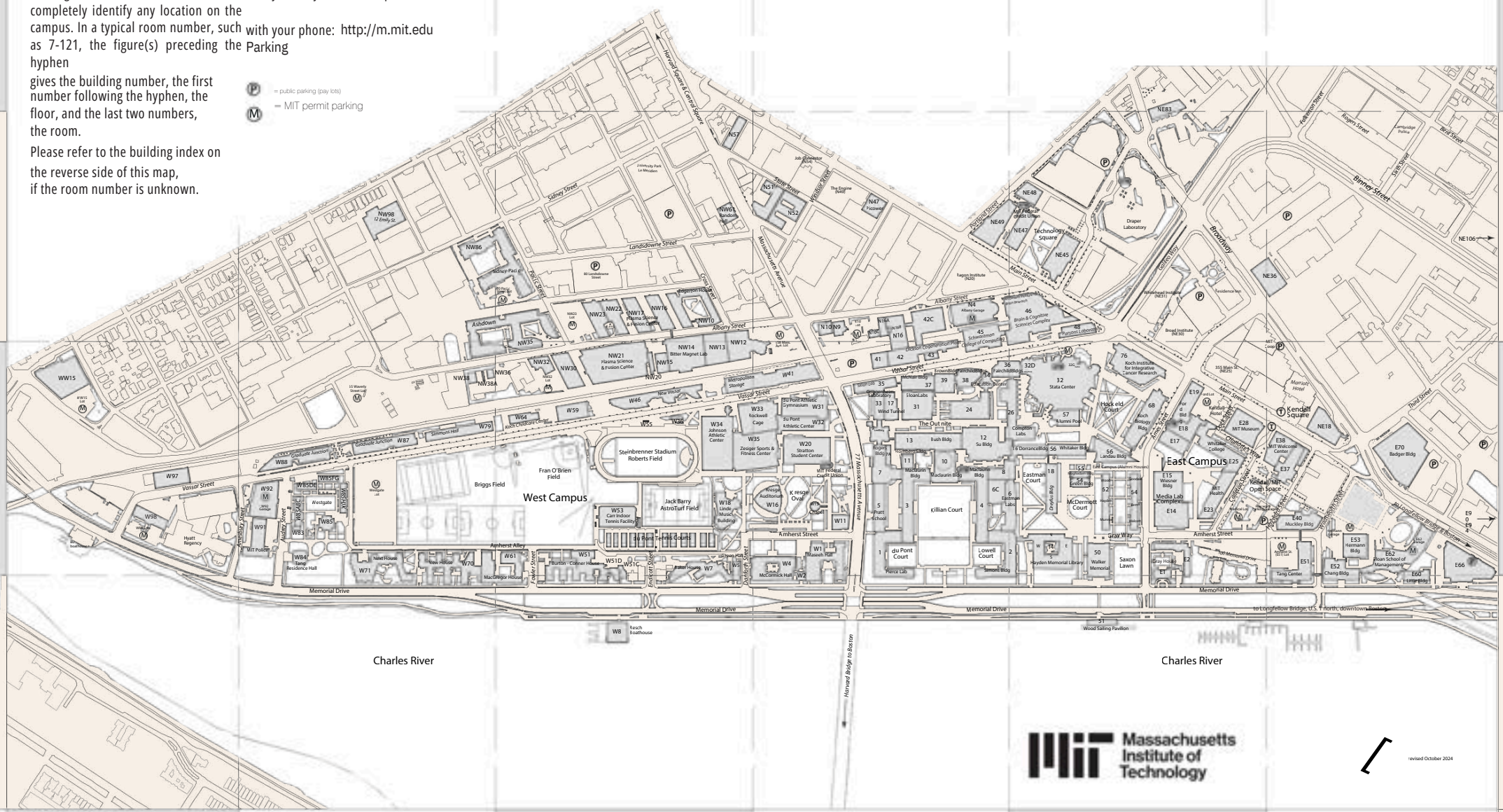
Use the online campus map: http://whereis.mit.edu/

Find your way around campus with your phone: http://m.mit.edu

Parking

P = public parking (pay lots)

M = MIT permit parking



AN INITIATIVE BY:

IN COLLABORATION WITH:

2026 An initiative by: Nepali Student Organization HGSE in collaboration with Harvard Undergraduate Nepali Student Association (HUNSA), Himalayan Caucus (HKS), MITeri (MIT).

Officially Recognized Student Organizations at Harvard and MIT
Sponsors: Filps and Fusemachines
Supported by: Leadership Academy Nepal and Kantipur Media Group